

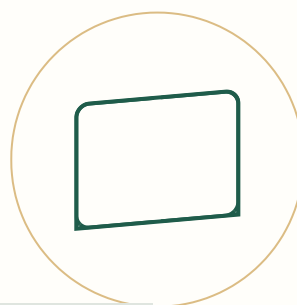
AL-AZHARI LIBRARY

مكتبة الأزهرى

Master Product Brief

Source of Truth

This document is the single reference for anyone working on this project — UX/UI designers, developers, copywriters, marketers, and the business owner.



DOCUMENT STATUS

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SOURCE

Business discovery session with the owner of مكتبة الأزهرى

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Master Product Brief

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HOW TO READ THIS DOCUMENT

Every claim is labeled. **Confirmed Fact** means the owner stated it directly. **Aspiration** means it is a stated goal or desired perception, not a verified market fact. **Open Decision** means it has not been resolved and must not be treated as settled. **Product Recommendation** means it is analysis/thinking built on top of the confirmed facts, offered as direction — not a business rule handed down by the owner.

1. Executive Summary

is an operating physical library and store in Qena, Egypt, founded in (AL-AZHARI LIBRARY) مكتبة الأزهرى 2023. It is **not a concept or a startup idea** — it is a real business with real inventory, real foot traffic, and real customers, some of whom already order from outside Qena through informal channels (Facebook, WhatsApp, phone).

Its core specialization is **Azhar-related books and educational materials** — a niche that, according to the owner, local competitors do not serve with the same depth. Around that core, the library also sells general-education books, school and university supplies, gifts, and packaging, and offers services such as printing, photocopying, binding, and student administrative services (applications, transfers, research/formatting help).

The confirmed operational problem is not "the library needs a website to look modern." It is that a business with strong product breadth and real specialization is currently running its entire sales and service process — discovery, pricing, availability checks, order preparation, and follow-up — through manual, one-to-one conversations across Facebook, WhatsApp, and phone calls. This works, but it does not scale, it consumes the owner's/staff's time on repetitive questions, and it caps how many customers outside Qena the library can realistically serve.

The product opportunity is to digitize what the library already does well — Azhar specialization, product breadth, a trusted local reputation, and responsive service — into a structured online store, without removing the human, WhatsApp-based relationship customers already trust. The website is a **second sales channel and operational tool**, not a replacement for the library, and not a pivot into an educational platform or LMS.

Product vision in one line: مكتبة الأزهرى، ولكن أونلاين — the same library, discoverable and purchasable online, with the same trust and the same person on the other end of WhatsApp when a customer needs one.

2. Business Identity

Attribute	Detail	Status
Arabic name	مكتبة الأزهرى	Confirmed Fact
English name	AL-AZHARI LIBRARY	Confirmed Fact
Founded	2023	Confirmed Fact
Location	Qena, Omar Effendi area, in front of Al-Rahbat School, next to the Azhar District	Confirmed Fact
Branches	One physical location; no branches currently	Confirmed Fact
Current channels	Facebook, TikTok, WhatsApp, phone	Confirmed Fact
Final phone numbers for the website	Not yet provided	Open Decision
Business hours	Sat-Thu 8:00 AM-11:00 PM, Fri 5:00 PM-11:00 PM	Confirmed Fact
Current slogan	"كل ما تحتاجه في مكان واحد" Everything you need in one") ("place	Confirmed Fact

What kind of business this actually is

The owner's own description — "أحسن مكان متخصص في الكتب الأزهرية في قنا" — positions the library at the intersection of four identities simultaneously:

1. **A specialized library** — its reason for existing is deep coverage of a specific book category, not general retail.
2. **A modern library** — it is meant to feel current, not old-fashioned or purely religious-supply oriented.
3. **An Islamic/Azhar-character library** — its visual and content identity should carry that character honestly.
4. **A student-focused library** — the majority of its customers and products are education-driven, not casual retail.

BUSINESS INSIGHT

These four identities are not competing — they are the actual value proposition stacked together. A generic bookstore does not have #3, and a religious bookstore rarely has #2. The combination is the differentiator, and the product/brand should protect all four simultaneously rather than optimizing for one at the expense of the others.

The name is a specialization signal, not a boundary

The name "Al-Azhari" describes the library's *center of gravity*, not the limit of who it serves. The confirmed customer base already includes general-education students, university students, and parents buying non-Azhar materials. The brand must communicate deep Azhar expertise **without implying** that a non-Azhar student, parent, or general-education customer is in the wrong place.

3. Brand Strategy

Brand values (as stated by the owner)

trust, expertise, professionalism — are the three words the owner used to — **ثقة** **خبرة** **احترافية** summarize the brand. Around them sit: knowledge, honesty, speed, quality, fair/appropriate pricing, and student service.

A recurring phrase the owner used is "**كل حاجة عندنا**" ("we have everything") — this is a confidence claim about *product breadth within the education/student space*, not a claim of being a general department store.

Brand promise (working formulation)

Al-Azhari Library brings books, summaries, school supplies, printing, student services, and related educational needs together in one trusted place, with deep specialization in Azhar content and the convenience of ordering online.

This is a **Product Recommendation** — a working value proposition synthesized from the discovery, not final approved copy. It should be validated and refined with the owner before being treated as brand language.

Desired perception vs. verified fact

The owner expressed the first-impression goal as: a visitor should immediately understand that Al-Azhari is one of the strongest destinations for Azhar-related books and needs. The phrase used for this ambition — "**أحسن مكتبة الأزهرية في مصر**" ("the best Azhar library in Egypt") — must be treated strictly as:

Aspiration / desired brand perception. It is not an independently verified market-leadership claim, and the product/content should never present it as an objective fact (e.g., no unqualified "the best" or "number one" claims in customer-facing copy). It functions as an internal compass for tone and ambition, not as a marketing headline to state literally.

The same treatment applies to "**احنا نقدر نووفر أي حاجة من كتب الأزهر**" ("we can provide anything from Azhar books") — this is the owner's stated *intended breadth and specialization commitment*, useful as a design principle (the catalog and site architecture should be built to support comprehensive Azhar coverage), but not a verified claim of total market coverage.

Existing visual identity — preserve, don't replace

A logo already exists and already carries: book imagery, Azhar/Islamic visual references, education and pen/writing motifs, dark green, and gold. The owner's explicit direction is to **preserve and unify** this identity rather than redesign from scratch. Any visual system work on this project should treat the existing logo as a foundation to build consistency around — not as a starting sketch to reinterpret freely.

Desired visual character: comfortable, easy on the eyes, Islamic in character, modern, professional, calm, trustworthy, and visually consistent with the existing logo.

What the brand must not become

- Not a generic, secular e-commerce brand that happens to sell Islamic books
- Not visually old-fashioned, purely religious-supply-store in appearance
- Not childish or casual — the audience includes serious university-track and Azhar-track students
- Not corporate/impersonal — the human, WhatsApp-based relationship is part of the brand experience
- Not repositioned as an educational institution, academy, or LMS

4. Business Model — How the Library Actually Operates Today

This section documents the *current, real* operating model, stated plainly enough that someone unfamiliar with Egyptian retail/education context can follow it.

Physical operation

The library is a single physical storefront in Qena that stocks books (with a specialization in Azhar-track educational materials), school and university supplies, gift/wrapping items, and games, and additionally performs in-house services: printing, photocopying, binding, and handling of student paperwork (applications, transfers) and research/formatting help.

Product sourcing and catalog size

The inventory is described as large and **continuously changing** — books enter and leave the catalog based on academic-year timing (see Seasonality, Section 7), and there is no fixed product count. Most books already have a photo and a price on file; **written descriptions still need to be produced**, and that work will be done by the library's admin.

Current sales/communication channels

Customers reach the library via Facebook, TikTok (awareness), WhatsApp, and phone. There is no formal digital storefront today — the entire commercial transaction (price confirmation, availability check, order build-up, payment method, delivery arrangement) happens through direct conversation.

Current payment handling

Confirmed methods in active use: cash on delivery, cash paid at the library, InstaPay, and Vodafone Cash. For non-cash-on-delivery methods, the customer sends **proof of payment (a screenshot)**, and the order is then reviewed by an admin before being processed. This is a manual verification step today, not an automated payment confirmation.

Current shipping and fulfillment

The library works with **Bosta**, **Egyptian Post**, and an **internal/local shipping partner**, and the library — not the customer — decides which carrier to use for a given order. Shipping cost is tied to governorate/location and is currently determined case-by-case in conversation. Customers can also pick up in person, which is free.

Current customer support model

WhatsApp is the primary support and relationship channel today, and per the owner, it is expected to **remain important after the website launches** — the website is meant to complement it, not eliminate it.

BUSINESS INSIGHT

Nearly every step of the current model — pricing confirmation, availability, payment verification, shipping selection — runs through a person, manually, per order. This is high-touch and builds trust, but it is also the single biggest constraint on how many orders the library can process per day, and the main reason growth outside Qena is harder than it should be given real regional demand.

5. Customer Understanding

Who they are (confirmed)

- **Primary audience:** students and their parents/guardians
- **Approximate age range:** 6–25 years old (student side)
- **Sub-groups within "students":** Azhar-track students, general-education (Ministry of Education) students, school-age students, and university students
- **Parents/guardians** purchasing on behalf of children, particularly for younger students
- **Geography:** primarily Qena, with a confirmed existing customer base in **other Egyptian governorates** — this is not a hypothetical future market, it is already happening through informal channels

EXPLICIT CONSTRAINT

the audience must not be reduced to "Azhar students only." Azhar specialization is the differentiator, not the ceiling of who the business serves.

What they need (inferred from confirmed pain points and product mix)

- To find a specific book or material tied to a specific grade, track, or subject
- To confirm a book is genuinely in stock before traveling to the store or placing an order
- To know the price without having to ask
- To get help with materials that are hard to find elsewhere (Azhar-specific texts, summaries)
- To get school/university supplies conveniently alongside books
- To get student administrative help (printing, binding, applications, transfers) from a place that understands what's actually required

What they currently ask about (confirmed)

Per the owner, customers regularly need to ask about: **product availability, price, product details, and order details**. This is stated directly and is the most concrete evidence of where the current experience creates friction.

What causes friction today

- Every availability/price/detail question requires a live conversation with staff
- Order preparation is manual and depends on back-and-forth to finalize details
- Customers outside Qena have no way to self-serve; everything routes through the same manual process regardless of distance

What builds trust (confirmed + inferred)

- The library's demonstrated depth in Azhar materials specifically — the strongest positive feedback identified is about **the library's deep specialization and availability of Azhar books**
- Responsive, human communication over WhatsApp
- Being able to pay cash on delivery or in person — a real trust mechanism in the Egyptian retail context, especially for customers who haven't transacted with this seller online before

Why they choose Al-Azhari (per the owner)

The stated reason customers choose this library over alternatives is that **Azhar content is treated as the core specialization** — not as one category among many — and that the library provides broad enough Azhar coverage that customers don't need to shop around for these specific materials.

What may prevent adoption of the online store

These are **Product Recommendations / anticipated risks**, not confirmed customer statements, and should be validated:

- Customers accustomed to instant human answers via WhatsApp may not trust a self-service catalog if pricing/availability information looks stale or incomplete
- Customers who have never paid online before may hesitate without cash-based options being equally visible and easy (they already are supported — this needs to be surfaced clearly, not buried)
- Customers with a service need (not a simple product need) may not understand that services work differently from products until the site explains it

Customer segments (**Product Recommendation** — for design/content use)

Segment	Description	Primary need	Status
Azhar-track student	Studying within the Azhar educational system	Specific, hard-to-find Azhar textbooks/summaries	Confirmed core segment
General-education student	Ministry of Education school student	Standard school books/supplies, seasonal materials	Confirmed segment
University student	Higher-education student	References, printing/binding, research/formatting help, applications/transfers	Confirmed segment
Parent/guardian	Buying on behalf of a student	Convenience, trust, correct materials for their child's grade/track	Confirmed segment

Segment	Description	Primary need	Status
Out-of-Qena customer	Any of the above, located outside Qena	Reliable shipping, confidence in ordering without visiting in person	Confirmed segment (existing, not hypothetical)

Deeper persona detail (motivations, decision triggers, objections) is **not available from the discovery** and should be marked **Open Decision** — **needs direct customer research** rather than invented.

6. Products & Services — Taxonomy and Business Role

Books are explicitly the **primary/core product category**; every other category exists to support the core business or to serve adjacent, real customer needs — not to dilute the identity.

6.1 Books — the core business

Includes: Azhar books, general education books, "platform" books (منصات), references, and summary books (ملخصات). This is the category the brand identity, specialization claim, and long-term differentiation are built around. **All other categories should visually and structurally sit around books, not compete with them for primary attention.**

6.2 School/study products — supporting category

School supplies, stationery, and educational tools. These exist because students shopping for books also need supplies — a convenience layer, not a separate business.

6.3 Other products — secondary category

Games, gifts, and gift wrapping/packaging. Explicitly secondary; the owner's brief and the "books are the core product" rule both indicate these should never visually overshadow books in the store's presentation.

6.4 Services — a structurally different category

Printing, photocopying, binding, and student services (research help, writing/formatting, applications, transfers, and other university/student-related administrative services). These are **not standard fixed-price products** — see Section 13 for why this matters and how it should be modeled.

6.5 Future category — store expansion, not identity change

Tajweed books, Qira'at books, Quran memorization center curricula, nursery curricula, and Qurans. The owner was explicit: this is a **future product/store expansion**, not a redefinition of the business into a broader religious-education platform.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION

the taxonomy above is also an attention hierarchy. Any future homepage, navigation, or merchandising decision should default to books first, supplies/services second, gifts/games last, with the future Islamic-education category treated as a genuine future phase rather than pulled forward prematurely.

Product data realities (confirmed, operationally important)

- Most books already have image + price; **descriptions are missing and will be written by the admin** — description writing is a real, unstarted content workload, not a placeholder concern
 - Descriptions should be **concise but sufficient to support a purchase decision** — not exhaustive
 - Prices change over time and will be updated by the business as needed
 - Products can be **temporarily unavailable** and must show a clear availability state
 - **Pre-orders** should be supported for currently-unavailable products where applicable
 - **No minimum order value**
 - Multiple products can be purchased in a single order via a cart
-

7. Seasonality — Business and Product Implications

Seasonality is described as **a significant part of the business**, not a minor merchandising detail. Confirmed seasonal patterns:

Period	Seasonal demand
July	Summary books (ملخصات)
August	Applications and transfers (استمارات وتحويلات)
September	School supplies

Additionally, books tied to a specific school stage/grade appear at the start of the relevant academic period and **gradually disappear** afterward, and seasonal offers/promotions occur.

How seasonality should — and should not — shape the product

EXPLICIT OWNER CONSTRAINT

the store must **not** become focused only on the current season. It must represent the **full library, year-round**.

This creates a clear design tension that the product must resolve deliberately:

- Seasonality should influence **merchandising, homepage content, and promotions** at specific times of year (e.g., surfacing transfer/application services in August, school supplies in September)
- Seasonality should **not** define the store's permanent structure, navigation, or overall identity — a visitor in, say, February should still perceive a complete, comprehensive library, not a store that "peaked" in September

PRODUCT RECOMMENDATION

seasonal merchandising should be treated as a temporary layer on top of a stable, comprehensive catalog structure — not as the catalog structure itself. This is a direct product implication of an explicit business rule, not a generic e-commerce best practice.

8. Competitive Positioning

The confirmed competitive landscape

Known local competitors: مكتبة الجهاد and مكتبة الشهيد, along with other local centers/businesses. This list should be treated as illustrative of the local landscape as described by the owner, not as an exhaustive, independently verified market map.

Competitor digital maturity (as assessed by the owner)

According to the owner, local competitors are generally **not heavily invested** in social media, digital presence, advertising, or strong online product presentation. This is the owner's assessment, not independently verified — but it is directly relevant because it defines the **digital gap** this project is positioned to exploit.

Al-Azhari's differentiation

The strongest stated differentiator is **depth of specialization in Azhar content** combined with the ability to cover Azhar-related needs comprehensively, rather than treating Azhar books as one category among many. Customers are described as choosing Al-Azhari specifically because this specialization is treated as central, not peripheral.

What customers may currently be choosing between (inferred, not confirmed)

Without direct competitor research, the specific reasons a customer picks Al-Azhari over مكتبة الجهاد or مكتبة الشهيد for a *given* purchase are **not documented** and should be marked **Open Decision** — **competitor comparison not yet researched**.

How the website should compete

The owner explicitly rejected an "everyone else is bad" positioning. The site should compete on **specialization, depth, availability, trust, professionalism, convenience, and a stronger digital experience than local competitors currently offer** — not on disparagement.

Competitive risk to watch

If a local competitor invests in the same Azhar specialization digitally, Al-Azhari's primary point of differentiation weakens. This is a stated concern from the owner and should be treated as a genuine strategic risk, not a hypothetical one — it argues for treating the Azhar specialization (deep catalog, credible content, fast digital service) as a moat to actively strengthen, not a static advantage to assume will hold.

9. Current Customer Journey (As-Is)

1. **Discovery** — via Facebook, personal recommendation, or other informal channels
2. **Contact** — customer reaches out (Facebook message, WhatsApp, phone)
3. **Requirement identification** — staff and customer clarify exactly what's needed (which book, edition, grade, quantity)
4. **Availability/price discussion** — staff manually confirms stock and price
5. **Order confirmation** — customer confirms they want to proceed
6. **Invoice/order preparation** — staff manually builds the order
7. **Physical order preparation** — items are pulled/prepared at the library
8. **Shipping or pickup arranged** — library selects the carrier for out-of-town orders; local customers may pick up
9. **Payment** — cash on delivery, cash in person, or InstaPay/Vodafone Cash with proof-of-payment sent and reviewed
10. **Delivery** — shipping cost paid at delivery where applicable

Friction points in this journey

- **Steps 3-6 are entirely manual and repeat for every single order**, regardless of how simple the request is
- There is **no self-service way** for a customer to check availability or price without initiating a conversation
- **Out-of-Qena customers go through the exact same manual process** as local customers, which limits how many the library can realistically serve at volume
- **No persistent order history** — customers cannot check status themselves; they must ask

BUSINESS INSIGHT

the current journey is not broken — it works, and it has built real trust. But it is a *linear, one-order-at-a-time, staff-mediated* process. The core product problem is converting the parts of this journey that are purely informational (availability, price, product detail) into self-service, while keeping the parts that genuinely need a human (service pricing, order review, support) staffed and easy to reach.

10. Future Customer Journey (To-Be) — Business Outcomes, Not Implementation

Stage	Before the website	With the website
Discovery	Facebook post or word of mouth only	Same, plus a searchable, always-available online catalog
Checking availability/price	Must message and wait for a reply	Visible directly on the product page
Understanding a book	Must ask staff for details	Product description written by admin, visible immediately
Ordering multiple items	Negotiated one item at a time in conversation	Added to a single cart, one checkout
Paying	Discussed and confirmed manually per order	Same methods (COD, cash at library, InstaPay, Vodafone Cash) but selectable directly at checkout; proof-of-payment upload for non-COD
Shipping cost	Determined in conversation	Calculated by governorate/location and shown before order confirmation , added to the total automatically
Choosing delivery vs. pickup	Discussed manually	Selected directly by the customer
Requesting a service (printing, binding, applications, research)	Explained fully over chat before any price can be given	Submitted as a structured request; library reviews and follows up with price/confirmation
Tracking an order	Must ask "where is my order?"	Visible order status; reduces repetitive status questions
Getting help	WhatsApp — the only option	WhatsApp remains prominent and available; self-service handles the repetitive questions so human time goes to real questions

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION

the website's job is not to remove the human element — it's to absorb the *repetitive, purely informational* parts of the journey (what does this cost, is it in stock, where's my order) so that human conversation is reserved for things that actually need a person: service pricing, edge cases, and relationship-building.

11. Product Vision

The online store must function simultaneously as six things, each with a distinct job:

1. **Digital storefront** — the first impression of the library for anyone who hasn't visited in person; must communicate specialization, trust, and professionalism within seconds
2. **Product catalog** — the searchable, always-current representation of what the library actually has, including availability state and pre-order status
3. **Service-request channel** — the structured entry point for services that can't have a fixed price up front (see Section 13)
4. **Customer relationship channel** — where a returning customer sees their order history and status, reducing "where's my order" messages
5. **Portfolio/brand presence** — a credible, shareable representation of the business for social media traffic and word-of-mouth referral
6. **Sales channel** — the part that must actually generate revenue; this is the definition of success (Section 18), not a side effect of the other five

PRODUCT RECOMMENDATION

these six roles should be treated as design constraints when evaluating any future feature — a proposed feature should visibly serve at least one of them, or it likely doesn't belong yet (see Section 20, Product Principles).

One-line vision: *مكتبة الأزهر، ولكن أونلاين* — a customer should be able to discover the library, understand its offering, find what they need, place an order or request a service, and follow up on their relationship with the library, without depending on manual messaging for basic, repetitive questions.

12. E-commerce Experience — Business and Customer Level

This section describes what the experience must accomplish for the customer, not how it is technically built.

- **Discovery:** a customer should be able to find a specific book (by name, subject, grade, or track) or browse by category without needing to know exact terminology
- **Product information:** each product should clearly answer — what is this, what does it cost, is it available, and (if not) can it be pre-ordered
- **Availability states:** must be unambiguous — in stock, out of stock, or pre-order-eligible — since availability confusion is a confirmed current pain point
- **Pricing:** visible and clear; prices are known to change and the business needs to be able to update them without friction
- **Cart:** supports multiple items in one order, no minimum order value
- **Checkout:** must surface all four confirmed payment methods (COD, cash at library, InstaPay, Vodafone Cash) and require proof-of-payment upload for the non-COD digital methods, consistent with the current manual process
- **Delivery vs. pickup choice:** explicit, with pickup clearly marked as free
- **Shipping cost:** calculated by governorate/location and shown **before** the customer confirms the order — this is a stated business requirement, not a nice-to-have
- **Accounts:** support order history, order status, and relevant customer information; customers should be able to cancel an order where applicable
- **Order tracking:** reduces the "where is my order" question volume that currently consumes staff time

None of the above should be read as a technical specification — no assumptions about specific technology, database structure, or system architecture are made or implied here; these are the **customer-facing capabilities the business needs**, to be translated into implementation separately.

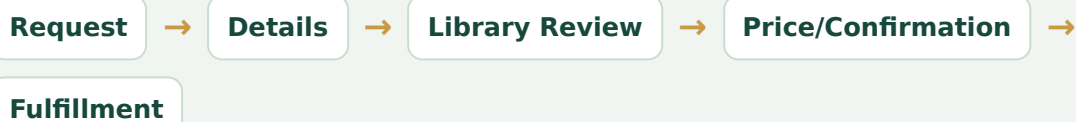
13. Student Services — A Structurally Different Product Model

This is one of the most important distinctions in the entire brief, and it deserves to be stated plainly:

A **book** has a fixed price and moves through: **Product → Price → Cart → Checkout**. A **service** (printing, photocopying, binding, research help, writing/formatting, applications, transfers, and other student/university administrative services) often **cannot** have a final price until the library understands the specific case.

Forcing services into the fixed-price product model would misrepresent how these services actually work and would create pricing promises the library cannot keep.

The correct model for services



- The **customer submits a request** describing what they need
- The **library reviews** the request and, where needed, contacts the customer to clarify details
- The **library determines final pricing** based on the specific case
- The customer **confirms**, and the library **fulfills** the service
- For applications and transfers specifically, the library performs the service **on behalf of** the customer — this is an active administrative service, not a self-service form

OPEN DECISION

the exact information required per service type, file/document handling expectations, and turnaround times are not yet defined and must not be invented. This applies to printing, photocopying, and binding as well — they should be **requestable online**, but exact workflows, file limits, pricing models, and turnaround times are unconfirmed.

14. Trust & Security — As a Business/Customer Requirement

Security matters to the owner **as a trust issue**, not as a technical specification. The business wants customers to feel that:

- Their accounts are safe
- Their personal information is handled responsibly
- Their orders are trustworthy (what they ordered is what gets fulfilled and shipped)
- Their payment process — including the proof-of-payment review step — is handled safely and reviewed properly
- The store overall is reliable enough to justify moving part of their relationship with the library online

This document intentionally does **not** define authentication mechanisms, encryption standards, or infrastructure requirements — those belong to a separate technical/security document. Here, security is a **brand and trust pillar**, on the same level as specialization and professionalism (Section 3).

15. Content Strategy

Content type	Purpose	Status
Product images	Help customers evaluate a book/product before buying	Confirmed — already available for most products
Product descriptions	Give enough information to support a purchase decision, concisely	Confirmed need — not yet written; admin-owned
Educational/editorial content (e.g., best summaries for a grade, back-to-school guides, advice for Azhar students, student guides)	Supports discovery, SEO, and positions the library as knowledgeable — supports the business rather than becoming a separate media product	Future Consideration
Seasonal content	Surfaces the right products at the right time of year (see Section 7) without dominating the site's permanent identity	Product Recommendation , built on confirmed seasonality facts
Social media integration	Connects the store clearly to Facebook and TikTok, supporting the goal of converting followers into customers	Confirmed business goal (see Section 16, priority 3)
SEO content	Increases Google presence (confirmed business goal) by naturally communicating specialization, location, and offerings	Confirmed goal — see caution below

SEO — a specific constraint from the owner

Google presence is a genuine business goal, but the owner was explicit that this must **not** come at the cost of readability, and the phrase "مكتبة الأزهر" must **not** be stuffed repeatedly into content. Content should naturally communicate specialization, products, services, and location rather than being optimized mechanically for keyword density.

Content ownership reality

There is currently **no dedicated person responsible for content or social media**. This is a real operational constraint that any content strategy recommendation must account for — a content plan that assumes a marketing team does not match the current business reality and should be flagged as an **Open Decision** (who will own ongoing content production) rather than assumed away.

16. Business Goals — Owner's Exact Priority Order

The following order was given directly by the owner and **must not be reordered or reinterpreted**. For each, this section adds how the online store is expected to contribute — this contribution note is analysis, not a restatement of the owner's words.

#	Business Goal (as stated)	How the online store contributes
1	Increase sales	A genuine second sales channel that operates outside store hours and outside Qena's physical reach
2	Reach customers outside Qena	Removes the requirement to physically visit or negotiate an order entirely by conversation; makes governorate-based shipping and pricing transparent up front
3	Attract customers from social media	Gives Facebook/TikTok followers a direct, credible place to buy, rather than a page that only builds awareness
4	Sell student services online	Introduces a structured request path (Section 13) for services that currently require a full manual conversation before any commitment
5	Increase Google presence	Gives the business indexable, discoverable content instead of relying solely on social platforms the business doesn't fully control
6	Expand the library's business in the future	Provides the catalog/content structure that future categories (Section 6.5) can be added into without restructuring the whole store
7	Present the library and its services professionally	A coherent, trustworthy digital presence that matches the quality of the physical business
8	Build a strong brand	Consistent visual identity, tone, and specialization message across every customer touchpoint
9	Organize orders	Structured order data replaces ad hoc conversation threads as the record of what was sold

#	Business Goal (as stated)	How the online store contributes
10	Reduce order preparation time	Self-service checkout removes the manual back-and-forth currently required to build every order
11	Reduce repetitive questions	Visible availability, pricing, and order status directly answer the questions currently asked over WhatsApp/Facebook

17. Product Goals

Product goals are what the *product itself* must deliver in order for the business goals above to be achievable — stated without inventing specific metrics that were not provided.

- Make it possible to discover, evaluate, and purchase a book **without a conversation**, for the majority of straightforward orders — supports goals 1, 9, 10, 11
 - Make governorate-based shipping cost and delivery-vs-pickup choice transparent **before** order confirmation — supports goals 1, 2
 - Give social-media traffic a direct, credible path from "interested" to "purchased" — supports goal 3
 - Provide a structured, non-fixed-price request path for services so they can be sold online without misrepresenting pricing — supports goal 4
 - Produce content and product information that is naturally search-discoverable without keyword stuffing — supports goal 5
 - Build the catalog/taxonomy so future categories (Tajweed, Qira'at, curricula) can be added without a redesign — supports goal 6
 - Maintain a consistent visual and tonal identity across the whole site, built on the existing logo — supports goals 7, 8
 - Give every order a structured, trackable record instead of a chat thread — supports goal 9
 - Reduce time-to-complete-order for both customer and staff — supports goal 10
 - Surface the specific information (availability, price, order status) that the discovery identified as the most repeated questions — supports goal 11
-

18. Success Definition

The owner defines success plainly: **the website becomes a real sales channel and contributes directly to the business.** Desired outcomes: regular orders, sales from outside Qena, customers relying on the website, student services generating actual orders, a strong online presence, and the website becoming a meaningful sales channel alongside the physical library.

The explicitly stated **worst-case scenario to avoid**: the website receives little traffic and generates little or no sales.

Success at each stage

- **At launch:** the catalog accurately reflects real inventory (price, availability, images, and at least baseline descriptions); all four payment methods and both fulfillment options (delivery/pickup) work correctly; the service-request path is functional for at least printing/photocopying/binding and student services; WhatsApp remains clearly reachable throughout the site
- **3 months:** the business can point to actual completed orders through the site, including at least some from outside Qena — not just traffic or visits
- **6 months:** repeat customers are using accounts/order history; staff report a measurable drop in repetitive availability/price questions arriving through WhatsApp/Facebook
- **12 months:** the site is a routine part of how customers order, not a secondary or rarely-used channel, and student services are generating real requests, not just inquiries

KPI TO BE DEFINED

no specific numeric targets (order volume, revenue percentage from online, traffic figures) were provided during discovery. These must be defined with the owner and should **not** be invented for this document.

19. Long-Term Vision (1-2 Years)

The owner selected **all** of the following as valid future outcomes, and they should be read as complementary layers rather than alternatives to choose between:

1. A strong online store serving customers in Qena and other governorates
2. A nationally recognized name for Azhar books and student needs, with the website acting as a major sales outlet **alongside** the physical library
3. A broader digital experience connecting books, summaries, school supplies, and student services

ASPIRATION

the long-term ambition includes becoming the leading Azhar-focused library in Qena, building a strong presence across Egypt through the website, and eventually having the online store function as a genuine sales outlet capable of competing with the physical library in sales contribution. These are stated ambitions, not projections with a defined timeline or committed investment plan.

The strategic direction remains constant throughout this ambition: a strong online store for the library — not a pivot into an educational platform, LMS, or startup, unless explicitly redirected by the owner in the future.

20. Strategic Layer — Product Thinking

Core Business Problem

Al-Azhari Library has real product depth, a real specialized customer base, and a real trusted reputation — but almost the entire sales and service process still depends on one-to-one manual conversation. This caps throughput, consumes staff time on repetitive questions, and limits how effectively the business can serve the out-of-Qena demand that already exists.

Core Customer Problem

A customer who wants a specific book, a supply item, or a student service currently has **no way to get a definitive, self-served answer** about availability, price, or how to order — they must always initiate and wait on a conversation, even for the simplest, most repeatable questions.

Product Opportunity

Not "sell books online" — the real opportunity is to **digitize the library's existing strengths** (Azhar specialization, product breadth, trust, responsive service) into a structured online experience that removes friction from the *informational* parts of the journey while preserving the *relational* parts that genuinely require a human.

Value Proposition

Al-Azhari Library brings books, summaries, school supplies, printing, student services, and related educational needs together in one trusted place, with a deep specialization in Azhar content and the convenience of ordering online. (**Product Recommendation** — *working copy, not final.*)

Differentiation

Deep, comprehensive specialization in Azhar books and materials, inside a modern, professional, trustworthy presentation — a combination the owner states local competitors are not currently matching, especially online.

Product Principles

1. **Simple over complex** — every added feature should be justified against a real customer or business need (Section 21, Business Goal 4 in the source brief: "*Does this solve a real problem for AL-AZHARI LIBRARY or its customers?*")
2. **Clarity over clutter** — availability, price, and next steps must always be unambiguous
3. **Trust over hype** — no unqualified superlative claims in customer-facing copy; aspirations are internal compass, not marketing fact
4. **Specialization over generic positioning** — Azhar depth is the anchor; other categories support it, never eclipse it

5. **Customer convenience over internal complexity** — services with variable pricing should never be forced into a fixed-price mental model just to simplify the system
6. **Physical and digital complement each other** — pickup, cash-at-library, and WhatsApp remain first-class options, not legacy fallbacks
7. **The store represents the whole library, year-round** — seasonal merchandising is a layer, not the structure
8. **Human support remains essential** — the website's job is to absorb repetitive questions, not to remove the option of talking to a person

Business Constraints

- No dedicated marketing/content team currently exists
- Product descriptions are largely unwritten and will be authored by the admin over time
- Return/refund policy is not finalized beyond the wrong-item/damaged-item case
- Exact service pricing models are not defined
- No paid advertising is currently running (planned to start post-launch)

Customer Experience Principles

Directly from the owner's stated core principle — "سهولة الاستخدام + تصميم مريح + ثقة" (ease of use + comfortable design + trust) — the experience must be: simple, clear, comfortable, organized, fast to understand, trustworthy, professional, and not visually overwhelming.

Strategic Priorities (synthesis, not a new list — mapped from Section 16)

In order: sales growth → geographic reach beyond Qena → social-to-customer conversion → services monetization → discoverability (SEO) → future scalability → professional presentation → brand strength → operational organization → efficiency → support-load reduction.

Risks & Unknowns

- **Execution risk:** if the site doesn't measurably reduce repetitive manual questions, one of its core justifications fails
- **Trust-transfer risk:** customers who trust the *person* they talk to on WhatsApp may not automatically trust a self-service catalog with the same confidence — the transition needs to preserve visible signals of the same responsiveness and honesty
- **Seasonal-drift risk:** without deliberate structure, the site could visually collapse into "whatever is seasonal right now," contradicting the owner's explicit instruction
- **Competitive-erosion risk:** the core differentiator (Azhar specialization) is defensible only as long as no local competitor matches it digitally — this is not a permanent advantage
- **Scope-creep risk:** future Islamic/Quranic product categories or educational content could gradually pull the brand toward an "educational platform" identity the owner explicitly does not want

- **Unfinished-policy risk:** launching without a finalized return policy or defined service pricing could create customer confusion or support burden if not addressed before real order volume arrives
-

21. Open Decisions — Consolidated

These must be resolved with the owner and must **not** be treated as settled facts anywhere else in this document or in downstream design/development work:

- Final phone numbers for the website
 - Detailed return/refund policy by product and service category
 - Which specific products/categories are non-returnable
 - Exact delivery time ranges by area
 - Exact governorates or areas excluded from shipping
 - Exact pricing model(s) for each type of student service
 - Exact information/documents required per service type (printing, binding, applications, transfers, research/formatting)
 - Any future products/services beyond the confirmed Tajweed/Qira'at/curricula/Quran expansion category
 - Any additional payment rules not yet documented
 - Any additional operational rules not yet documented
 - Numeric KPI targets for launch and subsequent periods
 - Detailed paid-advertising strategy (planned but not yet defined)
 - Who owns ongoing content and social media production
 - Any policy area not yet formally approved by the owner
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22. Future Opportunities (Not Commitments)

These are logical extensions of confirmed direction, explicitly **not** commitments or scoped work:

- Educational/editorial content (grade-specific summary guides, back-to-school guides, student advice) once a content owner exists
 - Expansion into Tajweed, Qira'at, Quran memorization curricula, nursery curricula, and Qurans as a distinct future store category
 - Paid social advertising once the store is live and can absorb the resulting traffic
 - Deeper customer segmentation/personalization once real usage data exists (not assumed today)
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23. Strategic Summary

What the business is: an operating, specialized library and store in Qena, founded in 2023, built around Azhar-track books and materials, serving students and parents across the Azhar, general-education, and university tracks — already selling beyond Qena through manual channels.

Why the product exists: to convert a high-trust but entirely manual, conversation-dependent sales and service process into a structured, self-serve-where-possible online experience — without removing the human WhatsApp relationship customers already rely on, and without replacing the physical library.

Who it serves: students aged roughly 6–25 across Azhar, general-education, and university tracks, and the parents who buy on their behalf, in Qena and increasingly across other Egyptian governorates.

What differentiates it: a depth of Azhar specialization that, per the owner, local competitors are not currently matching — especially not digitally — combined with real product breadth across books, supplies, and student services.

What success means: the website becomes a genuine, revenue-generating sales channel — not a brochure — with orders from outside Qena, functioning student-service requests, and a measurable reduction in the repetitive manual questions currently consuming staff time.

Where it is going: toward a strong, standalone online store operating alongside the physical library, with a long-term ambition of national recognition for Azhar books and student needs — while remaining, deliberately and permanently, a specialized library and store, not an educational platform or startup.